SMB Connect Quick Start

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1. Open SMB Connect

SMB Connect keeps a list of the important servers and shares you want to use, including an individual account for each share. It connects through your preferred fast network, such as `10GbE`, and can fall back to a slower network, such as `1GbE`, when that is better than having no connection.

For a regular Mac window, enable **Settings -> General -> Show Dock icon and desktop window**. The same app gains a Dock icon and resizable window while the menu-bar control stays available.

2. Complete Setup And Connect

1. Open `Settings... -> Shares`, choose a share, and confirm its Mount Name and network paths.
2. Save the username and password.
3. Press `Connect`, or use `Connect All` for every ready share.

Passwords stay in the user's Keychain.

3. Read The Status

A green check means mounted; `Fallback` means it used a slower configured path. In the Connection Summary, the speed uses neutral high-contrast text with a green dot for the preferred path or an orange dot for a fallback path. Blue dashed means ready to connect. Grey means no endpoint answered. Yellow or red means complete setup or follow the card's repair guidance.

4. Make It Automatic

In **Settings -> General**, enable **Launch at login**, **Connect all shares on start**, and **Auto-reconnect dropped shares** for hands-off operation.

5. Preferred, Fallback, And Warnings

SMB Connect tries paths in priority order: `10GbE`, `1GbE`, then an optional VPN. Fallback is still connected. Quit apps before `Switch to Preferred...`.

If Wi-Fi conflicts with required `1GbE` or `10GbE` storage, turn Wi-Fi off before connecting so the Mac uses the intended wired path.

- **Name conflict or duplicate** - inspect `/Volumes` and follow the card's guided repair.
- **Mounted by Another User** - ask that user to eject or sign out.
- **Offline** - no endpoint is answering; check the server and network.

For support, choose **Help -> Export Logs and Diagnostics...**. The report omits passwords and account names.

6. CopyTrust Mount Requests

CopyTrust can request an approved volume before ingest using the same Mount Name model as the older Desktop app:

```
smbconnect://v1/mount?volume=Example_Archive&request=<uuid>
```

In **Settings -> Shares**, enable **Allow apps to request this volume**. The Mount Name must be unique and its credential already saved.

SMB Connect chooses the best endpoint, reads its Keychain entry, and mounts. CopyTrust waits for `/Volumes/Example_Archive`, then checks its required folder. It receives no password, server address, or network preference.

MDM can enforce `allowExternalMountRequests = true`; passwords remain per user and per Mac in Keychain.

7. SMB Connect Desktop Compatibility

The separate **SMB Connect Desktop** app is no longer needed for new installs. It remains compatible and sends the same request shown above, but does not read passwords; SMB Connect remains the mount and credential authority.

More Help

Open `?` Help or read the full User Guide at https://github.com/macvfx/SMB-Connect/blob/main/USER-GUIDE.md.